

Subjective Underemployment Scale

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Indicate how much the following statements apply to you. For the following questions, consider your primary job where you spend the majority of your time.

- 1— Strongly disagree
- 2— Disagree
- 3— Slightly disagree
- 4— Neither agree nor disagree
- 5— Slightly agree
- 6— Agree
- 7— Strongly agree

Underpayment

- 1. My pay is less than other people with my qualifications.
- 2. I am paid less than those with similar credentials.
- 3. I am underpaid compared to those with my level of knowledge.
- 4. I earn less than people with similar skills.
- 5. I make less than others with my level of education.
- 6. My pay is lower than others with my level of experience.
- 7. I earn less than others with my level of ability.

Status discrepancy

- 1. My status at work is lower than I deserve.
- 2. I deserve a higher position in my company.
- 3. If it were up to me, my position at work would be higher.
- 4. My rank at work is less than it should be for someone with my ability.
- 5. I deserve a higher position at work given my level of education.

6. Given my credentials, I should have a higher position at work.

Hours discrepancy

For these questions, consider how many hours you work in your current job. If you have more than one job, consider the hours you work in all your jobs combined. Think of the amount of hours you work per week.

1. I need to find a job that allows me to work more hours.
2. I work fewer hours than I need.
3. I work too few hours.
4. I do not work enough hours.
5. I would work more hours if I could.
6. The number of hours I work is not enough.

Involuntary temporary work

1. My job is temporary, but I want a permanent position.
2. I work in temporary positions, but I would prefer not to.
3. I take short-term jobs because I have to.
4. I work in a temporary position, because I cannot find a permanent job.
5. I am forced to take temporary jobs.
6. I cannot find a permanent position.

Field

1. I am forced to work outside my desired field.
2. I had to take a job outside of my field.
3. I cannot get a job related to my education.
4. I am unable to work in a job related to my formal training.
5. I was compelled to take a job unrelated to my education.
6. I want to work in a different field, but there are no jobs available.

Poverty wage employment

1. My pay is not enough to live on.
2. The income from my job is not enough.
3. I barely earn enough to survive.
4. Despite efforts at work, my income is too small.
5. I do not earn enough, even though I have a job.
6. My job does not allow me to make a decent living.